HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

PRIVATE SCHOOLS IN AFRICA

The empty seat

Private schooling is already a mass market across much of Africa. Returns depend on how full the buildings are, and on who carries the land.



THE REPORT IN SIX NUMBERS

63% of Côte d'Ivoire's secondary pupils attend private schools; its population aged 15 to 19 grows 26% by 2035

18.9m private primary and secondary pupils in Nigeria, Ghana, Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon (Heirstone analysis); we found no listed school group in any of them

69 to 72% share of Curro's built seats in use in every year from 2018 to 2024; about 31,000 seats stood empty in 2024

US$5,600 book property per built seat at both Curro (2024) and ADvTECH (2025), equal to 1.2 to 1.5 years of fee or revenue per pupil (Heirstone analysis)

0.97x implied enterprise value in the 2025 take-private of Curro, as a multiple of its book property, plant and equipment (Heirstone analysis)

2.7m to 9.9m additional private pupil places in 13 markets by 2035 in two Heirstone scenarios: private shares held constant, or primary shares rising on trend

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report reads private primary and secondary schools in Africa as real estate: seats, land, buildings, capital per place and tenure. It draws on public sources current in 2026, including UNESCO Institute for Statistics data published by the World Bank, World Bank population projections, the accounts of Curro, ADvTECH and CIRA, operator and developer websites, ministry standards and development finance disclosures.

Where we combine published figures to produce a new one, the inputs are shown and the result is labelled Heirstone analysis. Local-currency amounts are converted to US dollars at World Bank annual average rates for the year stated. Universities and student housing are covered in a separate Heirstone report.

SUMMARY

Africa already has a large private school market. Full schools, and owners for the land beneath them, are scarcer.

About 30 million primary and secondary pupils attend private schools in the 13 markets we examine, yet the schools investors can measure and buy are mostly in South Africa and Egypt. Read as real estate, the sector turns on one variable: how full a school is.

1 **The largest private shares are in markets with no listed school group.**

Côte d'Ivoire has 63% of its secondary pupils in private schools; Ghana, Cameroon and Nigeria have 23 to 28% of their primary pupils. These four markets hold about 18.9 million private pupils and, as far as we could find, no listed school group. South Africa, at 5.8% of primary pupils, produced the two largest.

2 **Demand grows unevenly, and in Egypt it is moving into the secondary years.**

The population aged 5 to 19 in the 13 markets grows by 29 million to 2035, 62% of it in Ethiopia and Nigeria. Morocco's shrinks 6.5% and Tunisia's 14%. Egypt's holds steady while ages 15 to 19 add 1.5 million.

3 **The empty seat is the main risk.**

Curro grew average learners by 42% between 2018 and 2024 yet filled only 69 to 72% of its built seats each year, leaving about 31,000 empty in 2024: roughly R3.2bn (US$172m) of book property by our calculation. ADvTECH fills 84% of its existing capacity and CIRA in Egypt 94%.

4 **A built seat carries about US$5,600 of property.**

By our calculation Curro (2024) and ADvTECH (2025) each hold about R100,000 of property, plant and equipment per built seat, or 1.2 to 1.5 years of fee or revenue per pupil. Curro's 2025 take-private implied 0.97 times its book property. Mid-market fees, such as CIRA's in Egypt, favour compact sites built at higher density.

5 **Outside South Africa, schools pay back faster, and buying has been cheaper than building.**

ADvTECH's schools elsewhere in Africa earned a 33.7% operating margin in 2025 against 20.9% at home and, by our calculation, recover their property in about 4.4 years of operating profit, against 6.8. Regis Runda in Nairobi cost R85,600 per built seat; South African extensions cost R114,000 to R138,000 per added place.

6 **Development finance is largely absent from school buildings.**

IFC states that it does not fund fee-charging private K-12 schools. The finance we found is local, asset-backed or philanthropic: CIRA's EGP 600m ijara sukuk on four schools, a bank refinancing of Curro's low-fee Meridian schools and a foundation's purchase of Curro.

WHAT IT MEANS

Developers should reserve school land in the first phase of a community, build it in steps that keep seats full and price the plot as part of the demand plan.

Operators should grow where seats already fill, often by buying and extending, and keep land off the operating balance sheet where tenure allows.

Investors, lenders and DFIs can hold school property let on long leases to proven operators, underwritten on utilisation history.

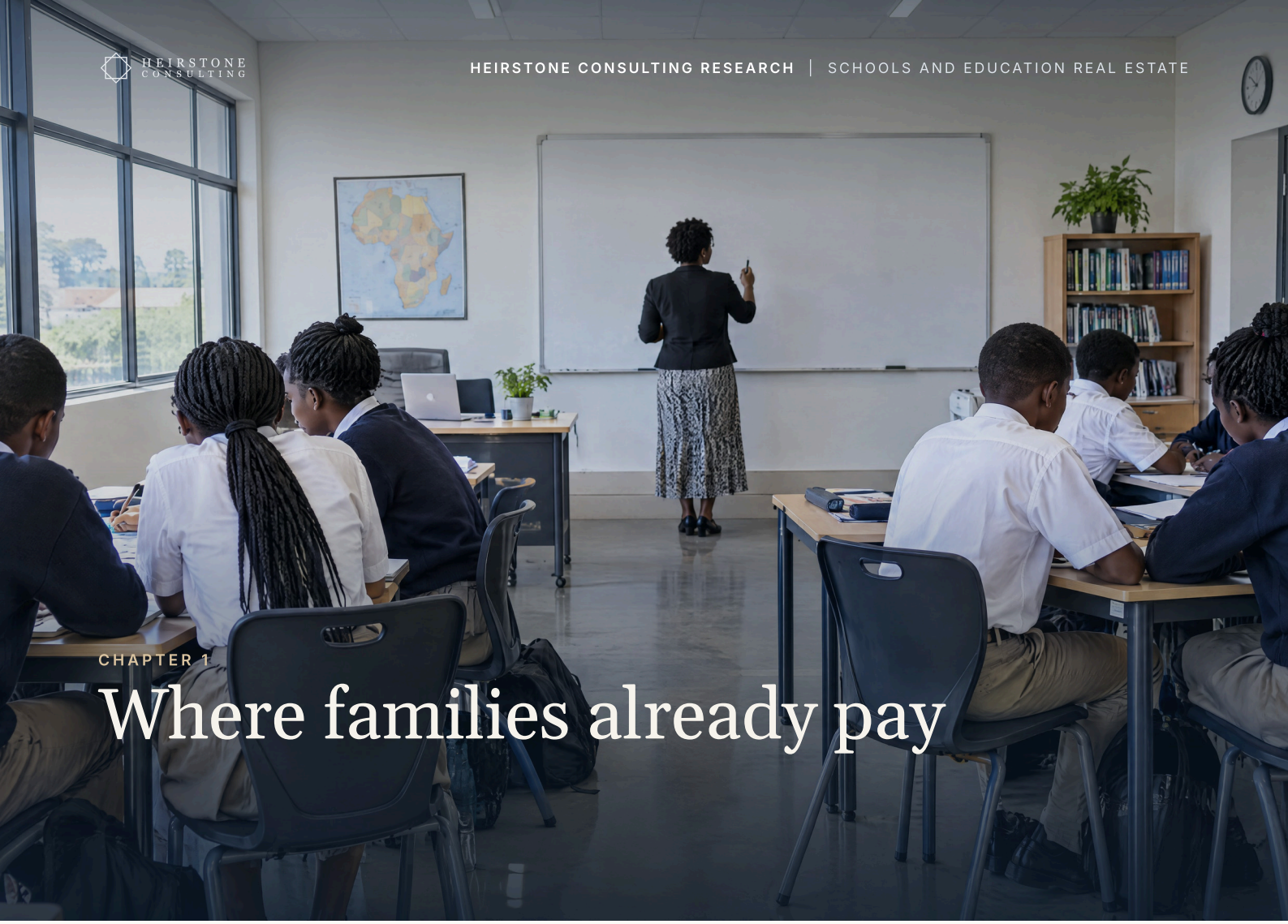
Governments and land agencies set the cost of a private seat through tenure rules, registration standards and the terms of school plots in new towns.

30.3m

private primary and secondary pupils across the 13 markets, by our calculation

40%

of them in Nigeria, about 12.0 million pupils



CHAPTER 1

Where families already pay

Private schooling in Africa is often described as a premium niche for expatriates and the well-off. The enrolment data say otherwise. The UNESCO Institute for Statistics, whose series the World Bank publishes, records 63.3% of secondary pupils in Côte d'Ivoire in private schools, 30.6% in Cameroon and 27.9% in Nigeria. At primary level Ghana records 28.4%, Cameroon 25.3% and Nigeria 23.3%.

These are mass-market shares. By our calculation Nigeria alone has about 12 million private primary and secondary pupils, four in ten of the 30 million across the 13 markets in this report.

The statistical definition of private is broad. It covers faith-based, community and grant-aided schools as well as commercial ones, which is why Mauritius, where most private schools receive state grants, records 56.4% of secondary pupils in private schools. For real estate the definition is the right one: it counts the pupils taught in buildings the state does not run.

> *In five of the 13 markets, more than one pupil in five is already in a private school. None of the five is home to a listed school group.*

12.0m

private primary and secondary pupils in Nigeria (Heirstone analysis)

63.3%

of Côte d'Ivoire's secondary pupils are in private schools, the highest share of any country in this report

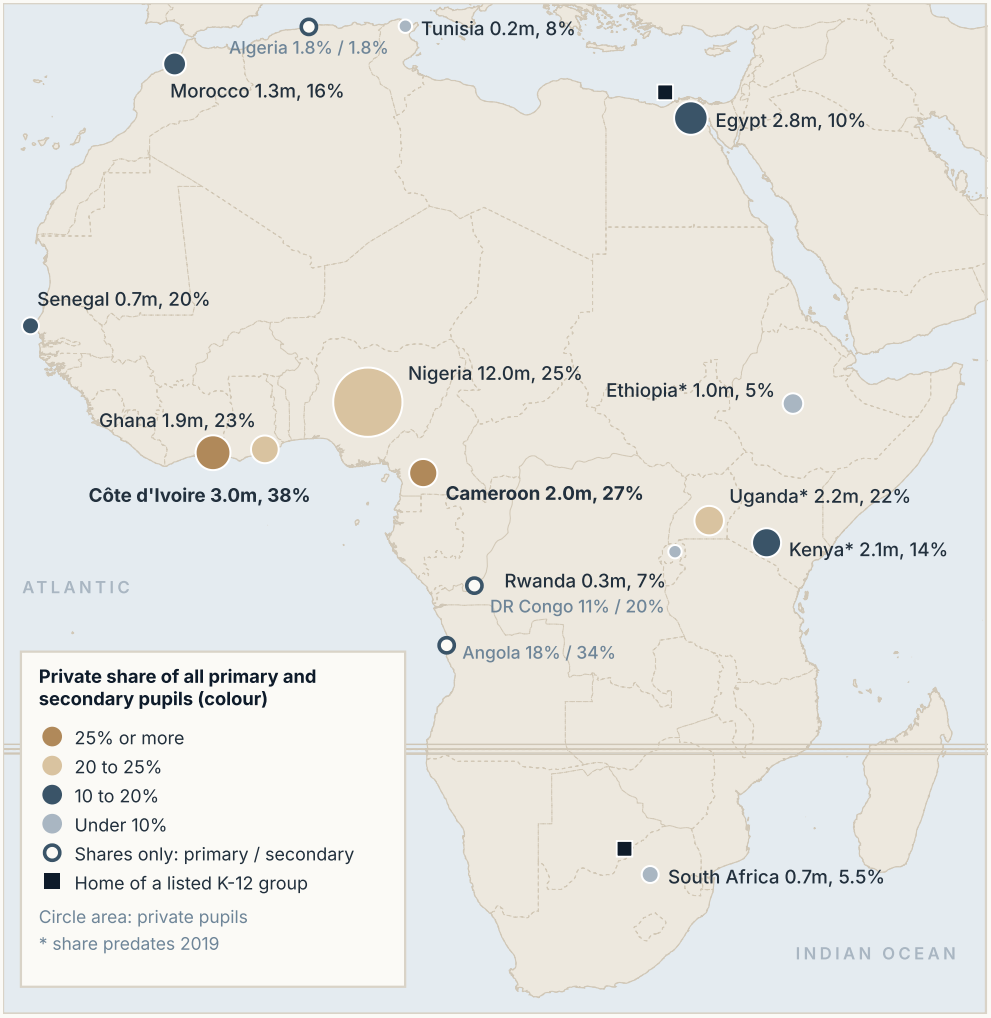
THE PRIVATE MAP

Private schooling is largest along the Gulf of Guinea, far from the continent's listed school groups

EXHIBIT 1

Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon and Nigeria have the highest private shares; Nigeria alone has 12 million private pupils

Private primary and secondary pupils, millions (circle area), and private share of all primary and secondary pupils, % (colour); latest UIS year, 2014 to 2024



18.9m

private pupils in Nigeria, Ghana, Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon

37.5%

Côte d'Ivoire's private share across primary and secondary

15%

of South Africa's private pupils are in Curro or ADvTECH schools

3

listed K-12 groups examined: Curro (delisted January 2026), ADvTECH and CIRA

Source: UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI (SE.PRM.PRIV.ZS, SE.SEC.PRIV.ZS, SE.PRM.ENRL, SE.SEC.ENRL), accessed 2026; Curro, ADvTECH and CIRA reports. **Heirstone analysis**: private pupils = enrolment x private share. Points are capital or economic-capital cities; positions approximate.

The map sets the size of each private market against its share. Nigeria dominates on size. Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon have the highest shares, at 37.5% and 26.8% of all primary and secondary pupils. South Africa and Egypt, home to the three listed school groups examined in this report, record 5.5% and 10.4%.

The listed groups are large in their own markets and small against the private pupil base. Curro's 72,109 learners and ADvTECH's 34,569 South African pupils equal about 15% of South Africa's private primary and secondary pupils (Heirstone analysis; Curro's count includes preschool and Namibian learners). In Nigeria, Ghana, Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon, with 18.9 million private pupils between them, we found no listed school group at all.

Schools serving those 18.9 million pupils do not publish accounts, so their utilisation, land and capital per seat are unknown. Investors who need audited data cannot price them, so from Johannesburg or London the asset class looks smaller than the enrolment figures suggest.

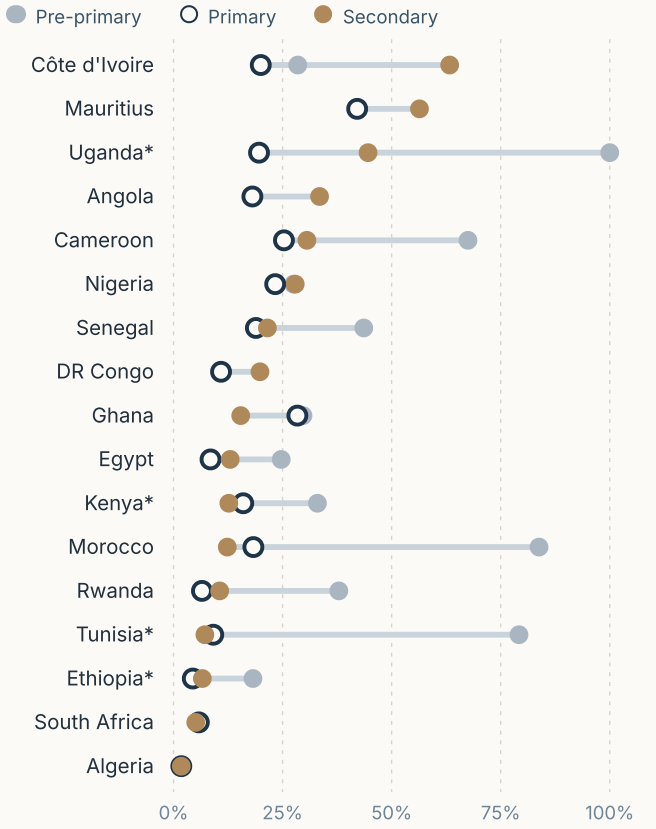
BY LEVEL AND OVER TIME

Pre-school is the most private level in ten of the 13 markets; in Côte d'Ivoire it is secondary

EXHIBIT 2

Private provision peaks before primary school in most markets and, in Côte d'Ivoire, after it

Share of pupils in private institutions by level, %, latest UIS year (pre-primary 2010 to 2019; primary and secondary 2004 to 2024)



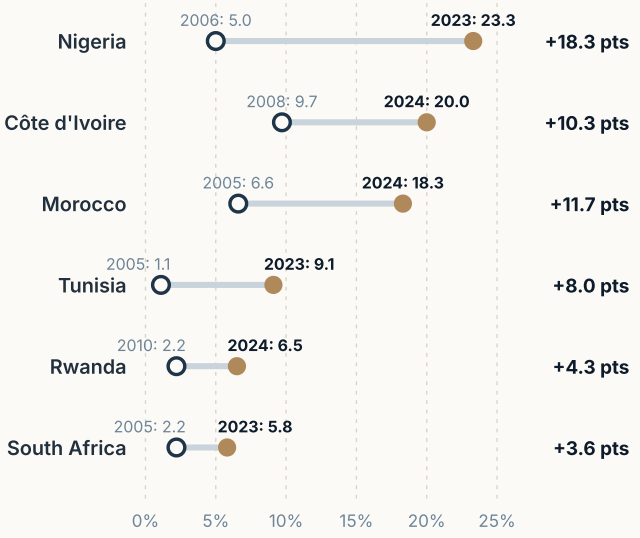
Source: UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI (SE.PRE.PRIV.ZS, SE.PRM.PRIV.ZS, SE.SEC.PRIV.ZS), accessed 2026. * Primary or secondary share predates 2019 (Kenya 2014 and 2009; Uganda 2017 and 2004; Ethiopia 2021 and 2015; Tunisia secondary 2016). Uganda pre-primary is almost wholly non-state. Pre-primary not shown where unavailable.

Pre-primary is the most private level in ten of the 13 markets. In Morocco 83.8% of pre-primary children were in private provision in 2019 and in Cameroon 67.5%; across Sub-Saharan Africa the share was 33.5%, close to the world average of 36.9%. For a developer planning a school plot, early years is the most predictable first phase.

EXHIBIT 3

Private primary shares have at least doubled since the first year on record, north and south of the Sahara

Private share of primary pupils, first year available since 2005 (ring) and latest year (dot), %; change in percentage points



Source: UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI (SE.PRM.PRIV.ZS), accessed 2026. The Nigerian series may contain definitional breaks.

Shares are rising in most markets where the series is long enough to tell; Egypt's has held steady at about 8.5% of primary pupils. Morocco's private primary share nearly tripled between 2005 and 2024, to 18.3%. Tunisia's rose eight-fold from a very low base, to 9.1%. Nigeria's is recorded rising from 5.0% in 2006 to 23.3% in 2023, although the series may contain definitional breaks. South Africa's more than doubled and is still under 6%.

Secondary is where the francophone markets stand apart. Côte d'Ivoire's 63.3% is the highest share of any country we examined, ahead of Mauritius at 56.4%. Uganda's last recorded secondary share, 44.6%, dates from 2004 and needs checking against national data.

The direction matters more to a property investor than the level. A rising share means new private seats are needed even where the school-age population is flat, which is the position of Morocco, Tunisia and, at secondary level, Egypt.

CHAPTER 2

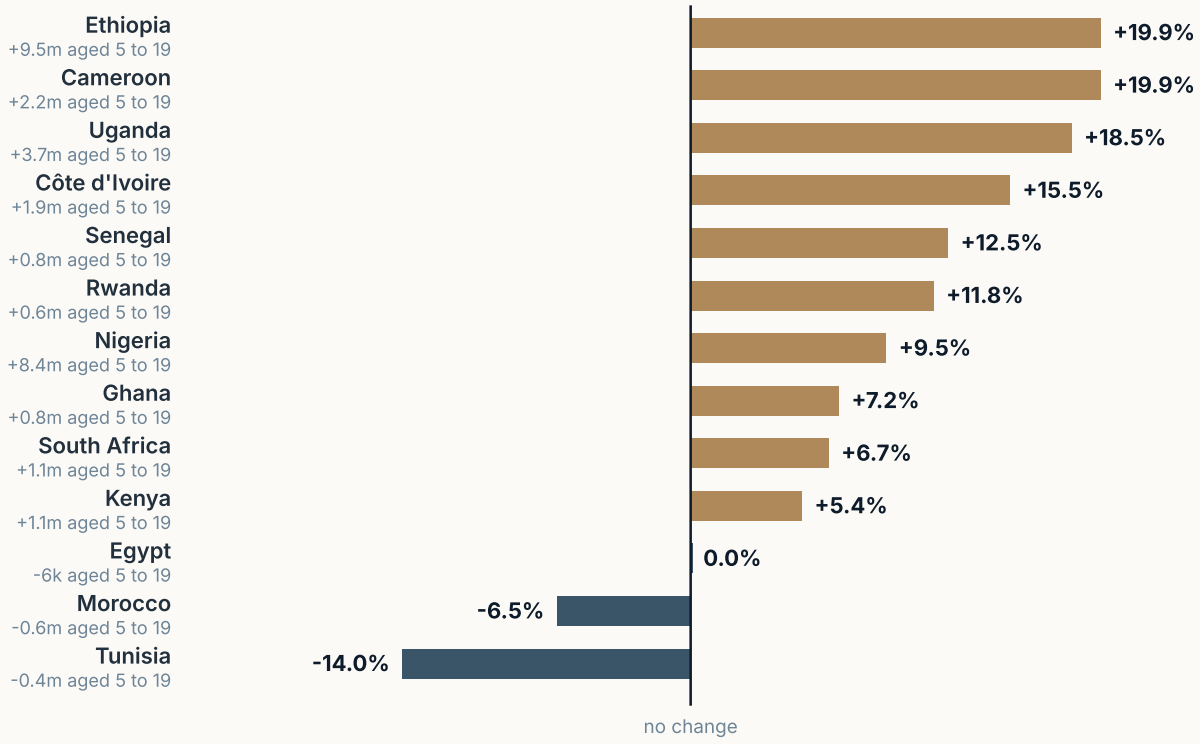
02 Counting the next decade's seats

Population growth adds pupils south of the Sahara and removes them in the Maghreb. Private shares decide how many of those pupils need a private seat.

EXHIBIT 4

Ethiopia, Cameroon and Uganda add about a fifth to their school-age population by 2035; Tunisia loses a seventh

Change in population aged 5 to 19, 2025 to 2035, % (absolute change beneath each country)



Source: World Bank, Population estimates and projections (source 40, updated July 2026), series SP.POP.0509, 1014 and 1519, male and female. **Heirstone analysis** summing six series per country.

Across the 13 markets the population aged 5 to 19 rises from 289 million in 2025 to 318 million in 2035, an increase of 29 million or 10%, on World Bank projections. Ethiopia and Nigeria take 62% of it, adding 9.5 million and 8.4 million. Cameroon and Uganda grow almost as fast as Ethiopia in percentage terms.

North Africa moves the other way. Morocco's school-age population falls 6.5% and Tunisia's 14.0%. Egypt's total is unchanged at 36.5 million, which hides a large shift between age bands. Population is only the first input: the number that matters for real estate is pupils multiplied by the private share.

AGE BANDS AND SCENARIOS

Egypt's growth is all in the upper-school years, and the private seat count turns on the trend in shares

EXHIBIT 5

Egypt's 15 to 19 band grows by 14%; Tunisia loses a quarter of its 5 to 14 year-olds

Change in population by age band, 2025 to 2035, %

COUNTRY	AGES 5 TO 9	10 TO 14	15 TO 19	5 TO 19
Egypt	-3.4%	-8.6%	+13.9%	+0.0%
Morocco	-9.2%	-8.4%	-1.9%	-6.5%
Tunisia	-26.9%	-22.4%	+9.9%	-14.0%
Côte d'Ivoire	+9.7%	+13.0%	+25.6%	+15.5%
Senegal	+16.4%	+10.6%	+10.2%	+12.5%
Cameroon	+13.9%	+20.7%	+26.6%	+19.9%
Nigeria	+9.0%	+5.8%	+14.2%	+9.5%
Ghana	+5.2%	+3.7%	+13.3%	+7.2%
Ethiopia	+16.9%	+25.7%	+17.6%	+19.9%
Uganda	+14.3%	+20.7%	+21.2%	+18.5%
Rwanda	+10.3%	+13.0%	+12.4%	+11.8%
Kenya	+10.6%	+3.8%	+1.6%	+5.4%
South Africa	+4.2%	+12.9%	+3.0%	+6.7%

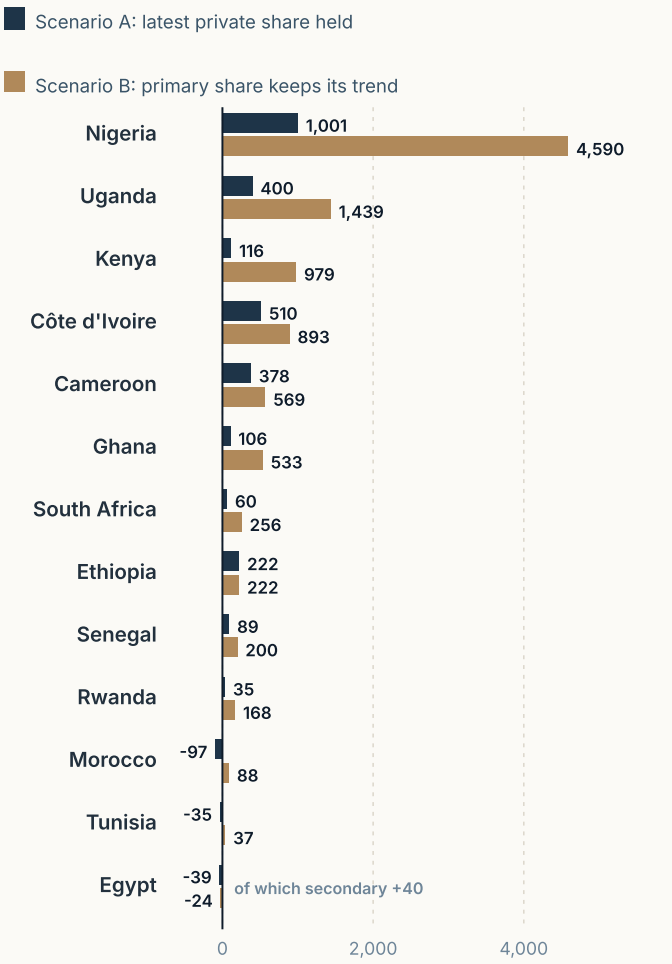
Source: World Bank, Population estimates and projections (source 40, July 2026). **Heirstone analysis**.

Egypt is the clearest case. Ages 15 to 19 grow by 1.54 million while ages 10 to 14 fall by 1.11 million and ages 5 to 9 by 0.43 million. New private capacity in Egypt is better placed in the preparatory and secondary years than in primary. Tunisia's younger bands fall by more than a fifth while its 15 to 19 band still grows 9.9%. In Cameroon and Côte d'Ivoire the 15 to 19 band grows by more than a quarter, on top of private secondary shares of 30.6% and 63.3%.

EXHIBIT 6

At constant private shares the 13 markets need 2.7 million more private seats by 2035; if recent gains continue, almost 10 million

Additional private primary and secondary pupils, 2025 to 2035, thousands



Source: Heirstone analysis of UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI and World Bank population projections. B extends each primary share at its past-decade pace, capped at +10 points, and holds secondary shares; Ethiopia held flat. Kenya, Uganda, Ethiopia and Tunisia use pre-2019 shares. Egypt's figures combine fewer primary seats with about 40,000 more secondary seats. A calculation that implies no forecast.

Scenario A needs about 2.7 million more private seats, 1.0 million of them in Nigeria and 0.5 million in Côte d'Ivoire, four-fifths of which are secondary. Scenario B needs about 9.9 million, 4.6 million in Nigeria. In Egypt the need is in secondary schools, which require about 40,000 more private seats in both scenarios; a smaller primary-age cohort means fewer primary places. Morocco and Tunisia turn positive only if their shares keep rising.

FROM PUPILS TO PROPERTY

The decade needs between 3 and 12 million private seats of capacity, and the bill depends on how they are built

EXHIBIT 7

At South African book cost, scenario A implies about US$18bn of school property; at East African purchase prices, under half that

Buildings, land and capital implied by the two seat scenarios for 13 markets, 2025 to 2035

MEASURE	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	BASIS
PUPILS AND SEATS			
Additional private pupils, 2025 to 2035	**2.75m**	**9.95m**	Exhibit 6
Seats of capacity needed at 85% utilisation	**3.2m**	**11.7m**	pupils / 0.85
Seats needed at Curro's 70% utilisation	**3.9m**	**14.2m**	pupils / 0.70
Schools of CIRA's average size (about 1,250 pupils)	**2,200**	**8,000**	37,434 pupils / 30 schools
BUILDINGS AND LAND, AT 85% UTILISATION			
Building area at Curro's 7.9 m² per built seat	**25.4m m²**	**92.0m m²**	814,816 m² / 103,621 seats
Land at Curro's 57 m² per built seat	**18,500 ha**	**67,200 ha**	595 ha / 103,621 seats
Land on Kenya's urban minimum plot (0.2 ha per 1,000-seat school)	**650 ha**	**2,370 ha**	0.5 acre = 2,023 m²
CAPITAL, AT 85% UTILISATION			
At US$2,455 per seat (Flipper, Addis Ababa, price per pupil)	**US$7.9bn**	**US$28.7bn**	R135m / 3,000 at R18.33
At US$5,590 per seat (ADvTECH schools, book value per built seat)	**US$18.1bn**	**US$65.4bn**	R5,710m / 57,100 at R17.89

Source: Heirstone analysis using Exhibit 6 and ratios from Curro (FY2024 long-form announcement), ADvTECH (FY2025 results), CIRA (9M FY2026 release) and the Kenya Ministry of Education registration standards (2022). Order-of-magnitude guide only.

Exhibit 7 converts the scenarios into buildings, land and capital, using the only per-seat ratios that Africa's school groups publish. At an 85% target utilisation, scenario A needs about 3.2 million seats of capacity; at Curro's 70% it needs 3.9 million. The difference, about 700,000 seats, is what building ahead of demand would cost across the region.

On Curro's ratio of 7.9 m² of buildings per built seat, scenario A means about 25 million m² of school buildings, 31 times Curro's entire estate. The capital range is wide: about US$7.9bn at the price per pupil ADvTECH paid for Flipper in Addis Ababa, and about US$18bn at South African book cost. Scenario B multiplies both by 3.6.

Land shows the widest spread of all. At Curro's density the scenario A seats would occupy about 18,500 hectares; on Kenya's minimum urban plot, about 650. Neither figure is a recommendation. The range shows how much of a school's capital is decided by planning standards and site choice before a classroom is built.

700k

extra seats needed if new schools run at 70%, as Curro has

31x

scenario A's building area as a multiple of Curro's 814,816 m² estate

> *Land per seat is a planning choice. Between a Curro campus and Kenya's urban minimum plot it varies almost thirty-fold.*



03

CHAPTER 3

Utilisation sets the return

A school's revenue follows the pupils it enrols. Most of its capital follows the seats it builds. The gap between the two is the main real estate risk in private schooling.

Curro, the largest of the three school groups in this report by learners and listed until January 2026, built ahead of demand. Between 2016 and 2019 it added 22 campuses; between 2019 and 2023 it added eight. Its average learners rose from 51,305 in 2018 to 72,638 in 2024, yet the share of built capacity in use stayed between 69 and 72% throughout. In the first half of 2025 learners fell 1.4% and utilisation slipped to 69.2%.

ADvTECH, the other large South African group, uses 84% of its existing school capacity. CIRA in Egypt uses 93.6% of 40,000 seats. Ethiopia's Flipper International Schools, which ADvTECH bought in 2024, received 1,300 applications for 300 places.

31,000

empty built seats at Curro in 2024 (Heirstone analysis)

4.3x

applications per place at Flipper, Addis Ababa

> *Curro's learners rose 42% between 2018 and 2024. In both years about three of its built seats in ten stood empty.*

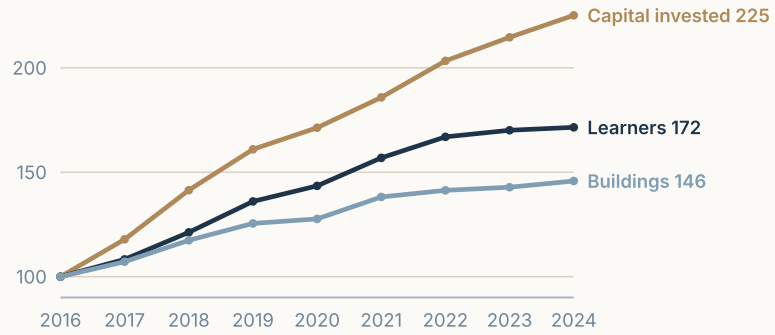
BUILT AHEAD OF DEMAND

Curro's capital base more than doubled in eight years; its pupils rose by 72%

EXHIBIT 8

Curro's cumulative capital has run ahead of its learners since 2016

Curro average learners, building area and cumulative capital invested, index 2016 = 100



Source: Curro Holdings, results presentation FY2023 and long-form announcement FY2024. **Heirstone analysis**: 2024 cumulative capital = R13,634m + R669m. Capital is in nominal rand, not adjusted for inflation, and includes acquisitions and maintenance.

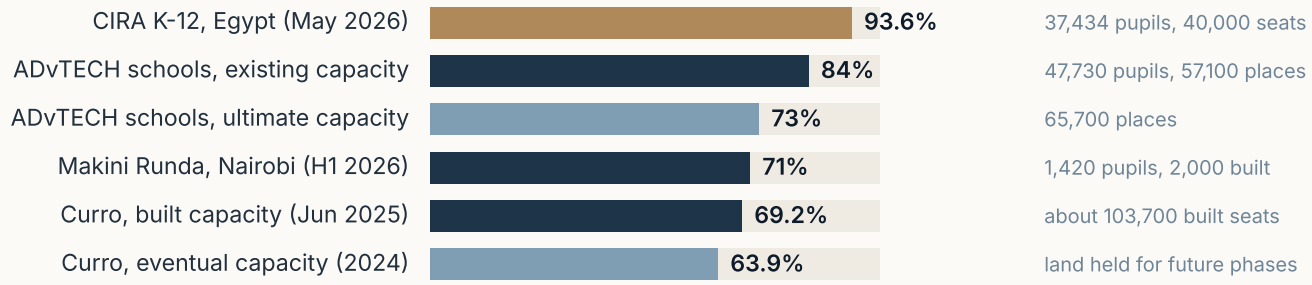
Cumulative capital invested rose from R6.35bn in 2016 to about R14.3bn in 2024. Capital per learner rose from about R150,000 to R197,000, while building area per learner fell from 13.2 to 11.2 m^2. Annual investment peaked at R1,493m in 2018 and fell to R669m by 2024.

Curro slowed building and kept enrolling, yet utilisation did not rise. Its campuses are planned for more than they hold today.

EXHIBIT 9

Curro fills about seven seats in ten; CIRA fills more than nine

Pupils enrolled as a share of capacity, %, latest reported; built or existing capacity unless stated



Source: CIRA Education earnings release 9M FY2026 (Jul 2026); ADvTECH FY2025 analyst presentation and H1 2026 interim presentation; Curro long-form announcements FY2024 and H1 2025. **Heirstone analysis**: Makini Runda 1,420 / 2,000; Curro built seats = 71,749 / 69.2%.

Two capacity measures matter. Built capacity counts seats in buildings that exist. Eventual or ultimate capacity counts what the site can hold when every phase is built. Curro reports room for about 30,000 more learners on its existing sites, and its eventual-capacity utilisation of 63.9% shows how much land it has bought ahead of need.

Operators that fill their buildings grow in smaller steps. ADvTECH said its R1,028m of 2025 capital expenditure was focused mainly on adding capacity on existing sites. CIRA runs 11.6 pupils per teacher against Curro's 17 to 18, so its high utilisation is not explained by crowded classrooms.

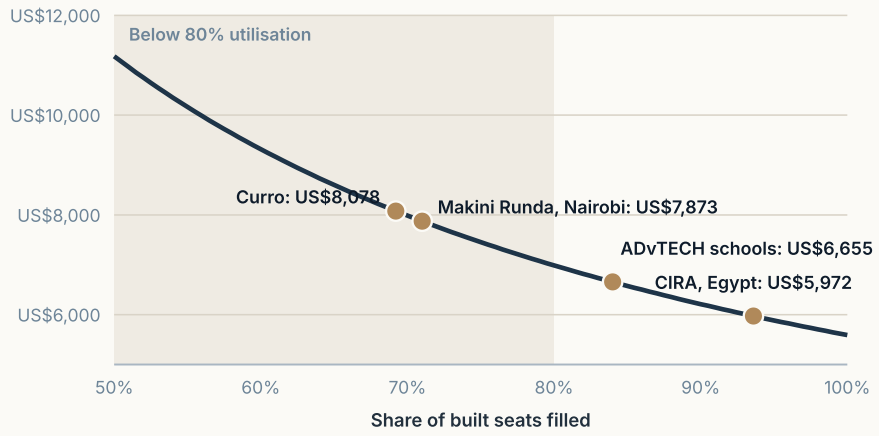
THE COST OF AN EMPTY SEAT

Below 80% utilisation, the property behind each pupil climbs steeply

EXHIBIT 10

At 70% utilisation every enrolled pupil carries about US$8,000 of property; at 94%, about US$6,000

Property, plant and equipment per enrolled pupil for a school estate costing US$5,590 per built seat (ADvTECH schools, book value FY2025), by utilisation, US$; markers show reported utilisation rates



Source: Heirstone analysis: property per pupil = property per built seat / utilisation. Inputs: ADvTECH FY2025 long-form results and analyst presentation; utilisation as in Exhibit 9. Markers apply one cost to all operators to isolate the effect of utilisation.

Property per enrolled pupil equals property per seat divided by utilisation. At Curro's 70%, R101,800 of book property per built seat becomes about R145,000 per learner, close to the R144,000 per learner implied by the price paid for the group in 2025 (both Heirstone analysis).

At FY2024 book cost, Curro's 31,000 empty built seats represent about R3.2bn of property, or US$172m at the 2024 average rate of R18.33 per dollar, earning nothing. ADvTECH's 9,400 empty places at 84% are a smaller load on a smaller estate. CIRA, at 93.6%, has about 2,600 seats left to fill.

Curro frames the same arithmetic as upside: filling 90% of eventual capacity would add about 40% to revenue from its existing estate. The question for an investor is how long that takes. Curro's utilisation did not move in seven years of growth, its bad-debt charge rose to 4.3% of revenue in 2024 from 3.3%, and new enrolment for 2025 was 1,018 learners lower than a year earlier.

Utilisation is also a design choice. A school built in phases, each opened when the previous one is close to full, keeps property per pupil near the left-hand end of the curve. A school built to its final size on day one starts at the right-hand end and may stay there.

R145k

book property per enrolled Curro learner in 2024 (Heirstone analysis)

R3.2bn

book value of Curro's empty built seats, about US$172m

40%

revenue upside Curro attributes to filling 90% of eventual capacity

4.3%

Curro's bad-debt charge as a share of revenue in 2024, up from 3.3%

04

CHAPTER 4

The price of a place

Two South African groups with different brands, fees and utilisation carry almost the same property per seat. That figure is the closest the continent has to a replacement-cost benchmark for a private school.

R100k

property per built seat at Curro and at ADvTECH's schools, about US$5,600

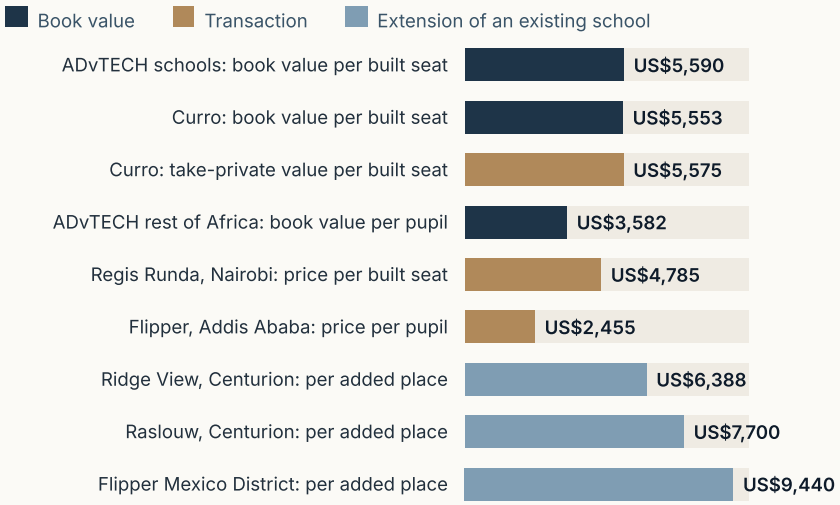
0.97x

Curro's implied take-private value over its book property (Heirstone analysis)

EXHIBIT 11

A built seat carries about US$5,600 of property in South Africa; buying schools in East Africa has cost less, and adding places more

Capital per seat, US$ at World Bank annual average rates (ZAR 18.33 in 2024, 17.89 in 2025 and 2026)



Source: Curro long-form announcements FY2024 and H1 2025, combined circular (Oct 2025); ADvTECH long-form results FY2025, analyst presentation FY2025, interim presentation H1 2026, Strategy Day transcript (Nov 2024); World Bank PA.NUS.FCRF. **Heirstone analysis**. Book values are historical cost. The Flipper Mexico District figure may include the site.

Curro carried R10.5bn of property, plant and equipment at the end of 2024 for about 103,600 built seats. ADvTECH's schools division carried R5.7bn for 57,100. Both come to about R100,000 a seat. The two groups differ in brands, fees and utilisation, which makes the convergence more useful as a yardstick for feasibility work elsewhere.

Marginal seats cost more than the average. ADvTECH's extensions at Ridge View and Raslouw in Centurion cost R114,000 to R138,000 per added place, and its new Flipper site in Addis Ababa about R169,000, a figure that may include land. Buying existing schools has cost less: R85,600 per built seat for Regis Runda in Nairobi and about R45,000 per pupil for Flipper's five schools, bought at close to three times EBITDA.

No operator outside South Africa publishes property per built seat for a whole estate. ADvTECH's rest-of-Africa schools, at about R64,000 of property per pupil (US$3,582), are the nearest proxy; much of that estate is leased.

R85.6k

per built seat paid for Regis Runda, Nairobi, in 2025

R114k to R138k

per added place on two Centurion extensions

3x

EBITDA paid for Flipper International in Addis Ababa

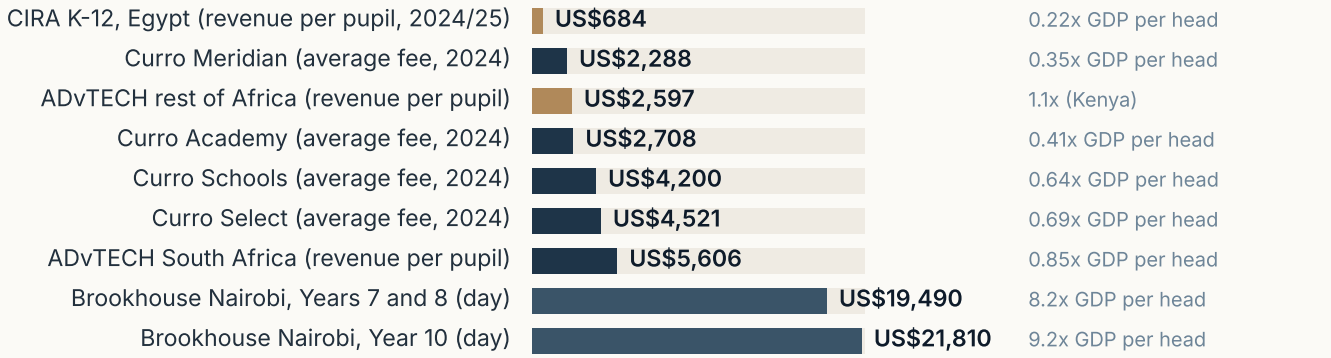
FEES AGAINST CAPITAL

A seat pays for itself in about a year and a half of South African fees; Egypt's mid-market fees favour compact, higher-density sites

EXHIBIT 12

Fees run from a fifth of GDP per head at Egypt's listed CIRA to eight times it at a premium Nairobi school

Annual fee or revenue per pupil, US$, and as a multiple of host-country GDP per capita, 2025; Curro brand fees are average monthly fees x 12, assuming 12 monthly payments

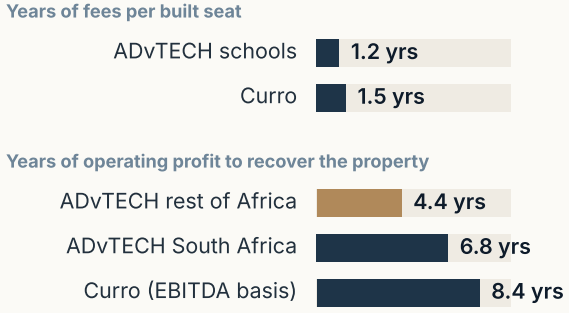


Source: CIRA earnings release FY2024/25; Curro Annual Integrated Report 2024 (average monthly fee x 12, an assumption); ADvTECH long-form results FY2025; Brookhouse Schools fee schedule, accessed 2026 (three terms); World Bank PA.NUS.FCRF (EGP 49.23, ZAR 18.33 and 17.89, KES 129.3) and NY.GDP.PCAP.CD. **Heirstone analysis**. Revenue per pupil includes ancillary income.

EXHIBIT 13

Seats pay back fastest where fees are high relative to property

Top: property per built seat / fee or revenue per pupil, years. Bottom: segment property, plant and equipment / segment operating profit, years



Source: Heirstone analysis of Curro FY2024 and ADvTECH FY2025 results. Undiscounted; ignores maintenance capital, ramp-up and land value.

CIRA collected about EGP 29,500 of tuition per K-12 pupil in 2024/25, about US$600 at the 2025 average rate of EGP 49.23. Fees at this level favour compact sites built at higher density, such as CIRA's 20,000 m² plot in New Rashid (Exhibit 14). CIRA's K-12 revenue rose 26% year on year to EGP 1,409.1m in the nine months to May 2026, and the group targets 70,000 K-12 seats by 2030, from 40,000 today.

ADvTECH's schools outside South Africa hold about R64,000 of property per pupil, earn about R46,500 of revenue per pupil and a 33.7% operating margin in 2025, and on segment totals recover their property in about 4.4 years of operating profit. The South African schools take about 6.8 years and Curro about 8.4 years of EBITDA. ADvTECH says teacher costs are around 20% lower outside South Africa. The rest-of-Africa margin was lower in the first half of 2026: 30.1% in the interim results announcement and 26.4% in the interim presentation.

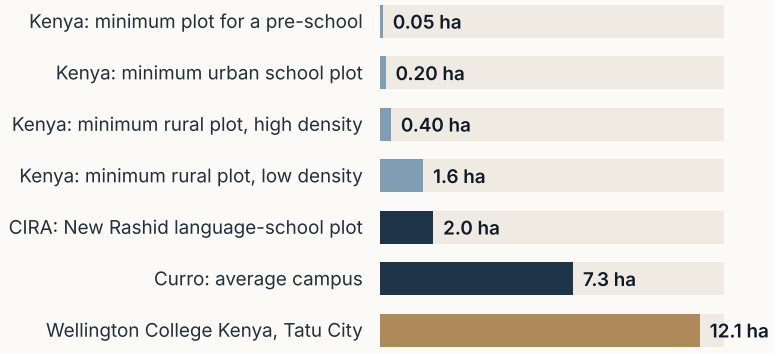
LAND AND BUILDINGS

A school site can be a fifth of a hectare or twelve hectares, and the choice sets the land bill per seat

EXHIBIT 14

Kenya will register an urban school on 0.2 hectares; a Curro campus averages 36 times that

Site area, hectares: regulatory minimums and published school sites



Source: Kenya Ministry of Education, Basic Standard Requirements for Registration (Dec 2022); CIRA Integrated Report (Mar 2023); Curro long-form announcement FY2024 (595 ha, 81 campuses); Rendeavour (2 2026). **Heirstone analysis**; 1 acre = 0.4047 ha.

Curro's 81 campuses average 7.3 hectares of land and about 10,060 m^2 of buildings for roughly 1,280 built seats. That is about 57 m^2 of land and 7.9 m^2 of buildings per built seat, or 82 m^2 of land per enrolled learner. Its estate grew from 578 to 595 hectares in 2024 alone.

Kenya's registration standards sit at the other end. An urban primary or secondary school needs at least 0.5 acre, a classroom needs 1.2 m^2 per primary pupil, and a school short of land may rely on a signed agreement to use a neighbour's playground. On a 0.5-acre plot, a 1,000-pupil school would have about 2 m^2 of land per pupil.

Between those poles sit the sites that developers allocate. CIRA bought a 20,000 m^2 plot in New Rashid for a language school; Wellington College International Kenya will open on 30 acres at Tatu City in 2028, with boarding, a 50-metre pool and an athletics track.

Building costs are rising. Curro's cumulative capital per m^2 of buildings rose from about R11,400 in 2016 to R17,600 in 2024, in nominal rand. Land per seat, by contrast, is set mainly by planning standards and site selection.

57 m^2

of land per built seat at Curro (Heirstone analysis)

7.9 m^2

of buildings per built seat at Curro

1.2 m^2

Kenya's minimum classroom area per primary pupil

36x

a Curro campus's average land area, against Kenya's urban minimum plot

THE HEIRSTONE SCHOOL ESTATE BENCHMARK

Twelve schools and groups, measured the way a landlord or lender would measure them

The benchmark compares operators and single assets on seats, utilisation, land and property per seat, fees, margin, payback and tenure. Only five of the twelve rows have a published utilisation or applications figure.

1 Property per seat converges

Book property per built seat is about US$5,600 at both South African groups. Purchases in Nairobi and Addis Ababa came in at US$2,500 to US$4,800.

2 Margins rise with distance

ADvTECH's schools outside South Africa earned 33.7% in 2025 against 20.9% at home, on about half the property per pupil.

3 Tenure is mixed

One group holds schools on short leases, a 99-year lease, state leasehold and freehold across three countries.

EXHIBIT 15

Two South African groups and one Egyptian group publish enough to be underwritten; the rest of the market is mostly dark

Selected metrics, latest published period (2024 to 2026); capacity shown as built / ultimate where both exist; US$ at World Bank annual average rates of the period; payback = property / annual operating profit (Curro: EBITDA); ADvTECH margins FY2025

OPERATOR OR ASSET	CAPACITY, SEATS	PUPILS	UTILISATION	LAND PER SEAT	PROPERTY PER SEAT, US$	FEE OR REVENUE PER PUPIL, US$ (X GDP PC)	MARGIN	PAYBACK, YEARS	TENURE
GROUPS									
Curro (ZA, NA, BW)	103,600 (calc)	72,638	70.1%	57 m²	5,553	3,864 (0.59x)	EBITDA 24.5%	8.4	Owned; leases 3.3%
Curro Meridian, low fee (ZA)	n/d	9,449	n/d	n/d	n/d	2,466 (0.37x)	EBITDA 26.0%	n/d	5-year bullet loan
ADvTECH schools division	57,100 / 65,700	47,730	84% / 73%	n/d	5,590	4,810	Operating 22.8%	6.2	Group leases 12.4%
ADvTECH South Africa	n/d	34,569	n/d	n/d	7,869 (per pupil)	5,606 (0.85x)	Operating 20.9%	6.8	n/d
ADvTECH rest of Africa (KE, BW, ET)	n/d	13,161	n/d	n/d	3,582 (per pupil)	2,597 (1.1x)	Operating 33.7%	4.4	Mixed: leases to freehold
CIRA K-12 (EG)	40,000	37,434	93.6%	n/d	n/d	684 (0.22x)	EBITDA 16.6%	n/d	Owned; sukuk on four
SINGLE SCHOOLS AND ACQUISITIONS									
Makini Runda, Nairobi (KE)	2,000 / 3,000	1,420	71%	n/d	4,785 (price)	n/d	n/d	n/d	Assets bought 2025
Flipper International, Addis Ababa (ET)	800 to 1,250 (new site)	3,000	4.3 applicants per place	n/d	2,455 (price)	n/d	Price c.3x EBITDA	n/d	Main site owned
Crawford International School (KE)	1,300 (from 900)	900	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	99-year lease
Legacy Girls' College, Akuse (GH)	n/d	400+	n/d	n/d	8,250 (fund equity)	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d
Brookhouse, Nairobi (KE)	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	19,490 to 21,810 (8 to 9x)	n/d	n/d	n/d
Wellington College International Kenya	n/d	opens 2028	n/d	12.1 ha site	n/d	n/d	n/d	n/d	Tatu City plot

Source: Curro long-form announcements, AIR 2024 and circular (2025); ADvTECH results, presentations and Strategy Day transcript (2024 to 2026); CIRA earnings releases and sukuk documents; Proparco (2020); Brookhouse fee schedule; Rendeavour (2026); World Bank WDI. **Heirstone analysis** for all ratios. n/d: not disclosed in the sources reviewed.

CHAPTER 5

Separating the school from its land

05

Land and buildings are most of a school's capital and, as Chapter 4 showed, they are recovered slowly. Who holds them decides who can grow, and how fast.

Curro owns almost everything. Its leased assets were R365m at the end of 2024 against R10.5bn of property, about 3.3% of its combined property base. ADvTECH's group figure, which includes tertiary campuses, is 12.4%. Its schools outside South Africa sit on a mix of short leases, a 99-year lease, state leasehold and an owned main site in Addis Ababa.

Kenya's rules show how short the regulatory floor can be: a private school may register on a renewable lease of at least eight years instead of a title deed. In Botswana, ADvTECH told investors, land cannot be owned and is leased from government at a nominal rent. Exhibit 16 sets out six ways African schools hold their property today.

EXHIBIT 16

Six ways to hold a school: the further property sits from the operator, the faster the operator can grow and the more tenure matters

Heirstone School Estate Models, with examples from published sources

	MODEL	WHO HOLDS THE PROPERTY	OPERATOR CAPITAL PER SEAT	TENURE RISK	GROWS THROUGH	AFRICAN EXAMPLES, FROM PUBLIC SOURCES
1	**Owner-operator on freehold**	Operator	All of it: about US$5,600 per built seat in South Africa	Low	Own balance sheet and bank debt	Curro, with leases at 3.3% of its property base; CIRA's owned schools
2	**Operator on long or state leasehold**	State or landlord holds land; operator builds	Buildings and fit-out	Low to medium, set by renewal terms	Lease terms of decades	Crawford International School Kenya (99 years); ADvTECH schools in Botswana, where land is leased from government
3	**Operator on a short lease**	Landlord holds land and buildings	Fit-out and working capital	High where the lease is shorter than payback	Speed and acquisitions	Makini schools, Kenya, largely on leased sites; Kenya registers schools on leases of eight years
4	**Property company and operating company, or asset-backed finance**	Investor or bondholders; operator pays rent	Low once refinanced	Set by lease and bond tenor	Recycling capital from mature schools into new ones	CIRA's EGP 600m ijara sukuk, secured on four owned schools for 84 months
5	**Site allocated in a planned community**	Developer, by plot sale, lease or joint venture	Varies; terms rarely published	Tied to the master plan and its phasing	Following the developer's build-out	Nova Pioneer and Wellington at Tatu City; SABIS at the New Administrative Capital, Zenata and Two Rivers
6	**State buildings with partner management**	Government	None for the partner	Contract and programme terms	Government programmes	State programmes supported by NewGlobe in Nigeria, Kenya, Rwanda and Liberia; it reports serving 4 million or more students in seven countries

Source: Heirstone analysis. Examples: Curro AFS 2024; ADvTECH Strategy Day transcript (Nov 2024); Kenya Ministry of Education (2022); CIRA sukuk EGM material (Dec 2020); Nova Pioneer, SABIS and Rendeavour websites (2026); NewGlobe website (2026). Tenure-risk and capital columns are Heirstone assessments.

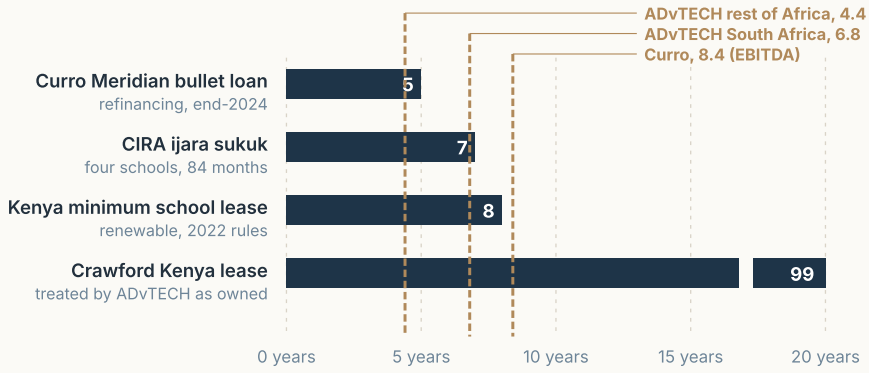
TENURE AGAINST PAYBACK

Most published leases and loans are shorter than the time a school takes to pay for its buildings

EXHIBIT 17

Kenya's eight-year minimum lease covers ADvTECH's faster paybacks with little room, and not Curro's

Lease and finance terms (bars) against simple payback on school property (dashed lines), years



Source: Curro long-form announcement FY2024; CIRA sukuk EGM material (Dec 2020); Kenya Ministry of Education registration standards (2022); ADvTECH Strategy Day transcript (Nov 2024). Paybacks: **Heirstone analysis** as in Exhibit 13.

A lease shorter than the payback leaves the operator exposed at renewal, just as the school reaches maturity. Kenya's eight-year floor leaves about three and a half years of headroom over ADvTECH's 4.4-year payback outside South Africa, little enough once a new school's ramp-up is counted. Long leases, such as Crawford's 99 years in Nairobi, are treated by the operator as ownership.

The 2025 take-private of Curro is the clearest market price for an African school estate. The Jannie Mouton Stigting, a public benefit trust, offered R13 a share, a 60% premium to the closing price on 25 August 2025, paid mostly in Capitec and PSG Financial Services shares. With 564.9 million shares in issue and R3.0bn of net debt at June 2025, the implied enterprise value was about R10.3bn: 0.97 times book property and about R99,700 per built seat (Heirstone analysis).

On our reading, that price was close to the historical cost of 595 hectares and 818,000 m^2 of school buildings, leaving little for the operating business unless the campuses were worth less than their cost. Curro now operates as an unlisted non-profit company and public benefit organisation that reinvests its surpluses.

Curro's net debt was about 28% of its book property at June 2025 (Heirstone analysis). An estate with debt at that level could support a separate property vehicle, and a non-profit owner is a natural landlord for pension funds or insurers seeking long, inflation-linked rents.

R10.3bn

implied enterprise value of Curro at R13 a share (Heirstone analysis)

99.98%

of votes cast in favour of the scheme, October 2025

28%

Curro's net debt as a share of book property, June 2025

8 yrs

minimum lease on which a Kenyan private school can register

WHO FINANCES SCHOOL PROPERTY

Local markets, foundations and operators have financed African school property while development finance has mostly stayed away

EXHIBIT 18

School finance in Africa is local, asset-backed or philanthropic; development finance in education sits mostly in funds, universities and housing

Selected financings of K-12 operators and school property, with one student-housing precedent, 2011 to 2026

INVESTOR OR LENDER	ASSET OR BORROWER	COUNTRY	INSTRUMENT	AMOUNT	YEAR
Jannie Mouton Stigting (public benefit trust)	Curro, take-private	ZA	Scheme at R13 a share, mainly in listed shares	Equity about R7.3bn (US$410m)	2025-26
Standard Bank	Curro's Meridian low-fee schools	ZA	Five-year bullet loan, refinancing	n/d	2024
EFG Hermes (lead arranger)	CIRA, four owned schools	EG	Ijara sukuk, 84 months; EGP 254m outstanding Feb 2026	EGP 600m	2020
ADvTECH	Regis Runda Academy, Nairobi	KE	Asset acquisition	R171.2m (US$9.6m)	2025
ADvTECH	Flipper International (5 schools)	ET	Acquisition at about 3x EBITDA, internally funded	About R135m (US$7.4m)	2024
Proparco FISEA, via Oasis Africa Fund	Legacy Girls' College, Akuse	GH	US$7m into the fund (2016); fund equity in the school	US$3.3m	2016-20
IFC	CIRA	EG	Convertible note, repaid in full 2014	n/d	2011
IFC (policy)	Fee-charging private K-12 schools	Global	Stated exclusion; education portfolio US$543m	n/a	2026
GuarantCo and EAIF (PIDG)	Acorn student housing notes (precedent outside K-12)	KE	50% guarantee; Moody's B1, one notch above the sovereign	KES 4.3bn raised	2019

Source: Curro firm intention announcement and circular (2025), long-form FY2024; CIRA sukuk EGM material (2020), credentials deck (Apr 2025) and 1H FY2026 release; ADvTECH FY2025 results and Strategy Day transcript; Proparco (2020); IFC education page (accessed 2026); PIDG (Oct 2019). US$ at World Bank annual average rates of the deal year (**Heirstone analysis**); EGP and KES amounts are shown in local currency because exchange rates have moved since the deal year.

Development finance institutions have largely left school buildings to others. IFC states that it does not fund fee-charging private K-12 schools, although it held a convertible note in Egypt's CIRA from 2011 until it was repaid in 2014. The only DFI-linked K-12 school investment we could verify is indirect: Proparco's FISEA fund put US$7m into the Oasis Africa Fund in 2016, which invested US$3.3m in Legacy Girls' College in Ghana, a school that grew from 13 to just over 400 students in four years.

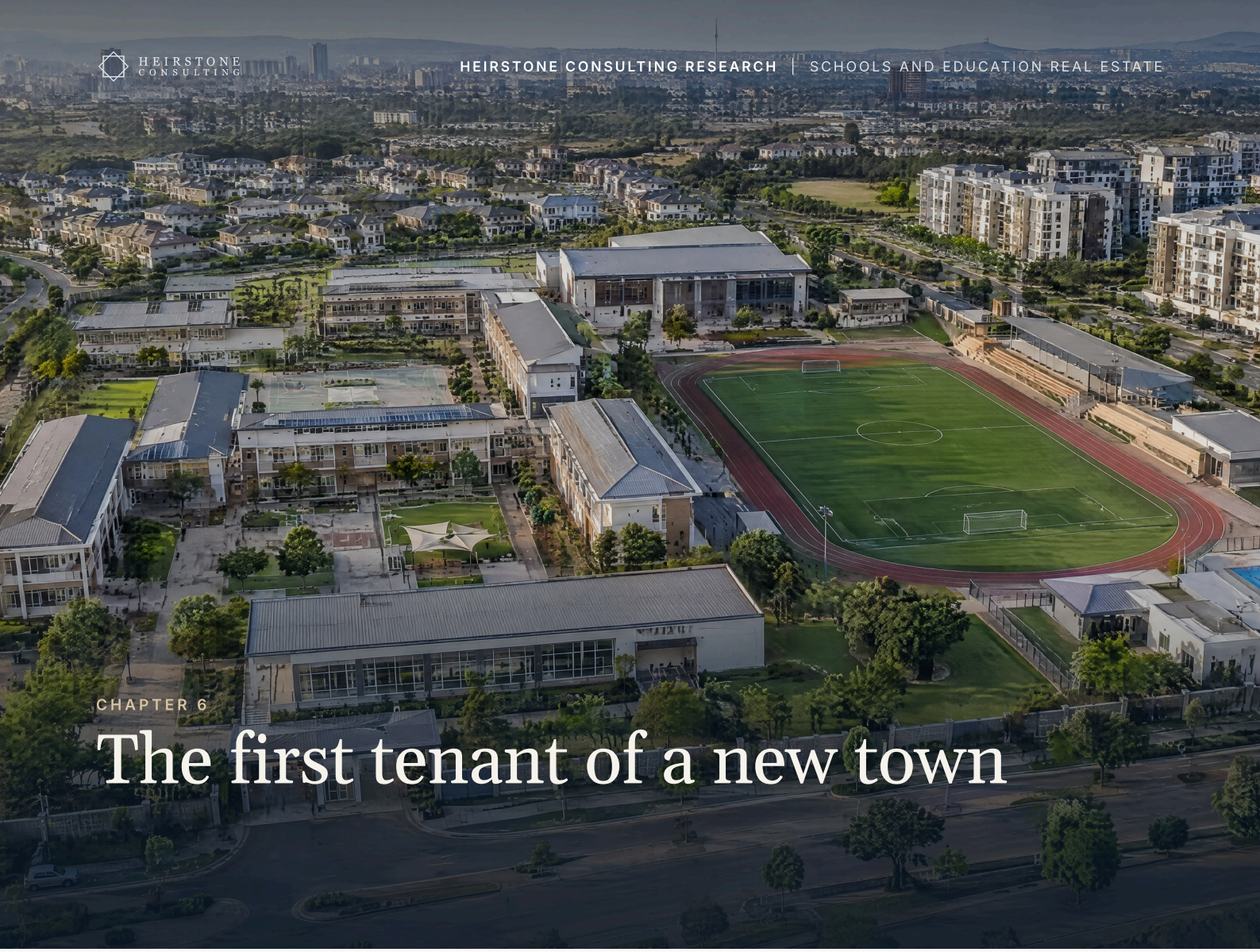
Local capital markets have done more. CIRA's sukuk, arranged in 2020 and secured on four of its own schools, refinanced their cost to fund expansion; it works much like a sale and leaseback, and the structure could be used again. Kenya's Acorn notes, a student-housing case covered in our separate report on universities, show what a partial guarantee can do: GuarantCo's 50% cover helped the notes reach a Moody's B1 rating, one notch above Kenya's sovereign B2 at the time.

US$8,250

fund equity per enrolled pupil at Legacy Girls' College (Heirstone analysis)

US$3.1bn

invested by IFC in education since 2000; it no longer funds fee-charging K-12 schools



CHAPTER 6

The first tenant of a new town

Developers across Africa have begun to treat schools as infrastructure. Rendeavour's Tatu City, a 2,000-hectare new city north of Nairobi, reports more than 6,000 students against just over 7,000 residents. On those figures most pupils are likely to travel in from outside, so the schools bring a daily population almost as large as the resident one. Nova Pioneer runs three schools on one campus there, and Wellington College International Kenya will open on a 30-acre site in September 2028. Rendeavour has created a head of education role alongside it.

SABIS's African schools sit largely inside planned communities: CADMUS schools at Alburouj in Shorouk and in the R3 district of Egypt's New Administrative Capital, CADMUS Zenata in Morocco's Zenata Eco-City and SABIS Runda at Two Rivers in Nairobi. CIRA is opening Futures Language School in Gardenia City. Few developers publish what a school pays for its land, how many seats it has or how full it is.

6,000+

students at Tatu City, against just over 7,000 residents

12.1 ha

site for Wellington College International Kenya, opening 2028

SCHOOLS IN THE MASTER PLAN

From Tatu City to Zenata, schools are being written into master plans, usually without published terms

EXHIBIT 19

Developers in Kenya, Egypt, Morocco, Nigeria and Ghana now name a school or campus as an anchor of their communities

Master-planned communities with a named school or campus, as published by developers and operators, 2026

COMMUNITY	DEVELOPER	COUNTRY	SCALE	EDUCATION ANCHOR	STATUS
Tatu City	Rendeavour	Kenya	2,000 ha; 7,000+ residents; designed for 250,000	Nova Pioneer (three schools); Wellington College International Kenya (30 acres)	Operating; Wellington Sep 2028
Two Rivers, Nairobi	n/d	Kenya	n/d	SABIS Runda	Listed by SABIS
New Administrative Capital	ACUD	Egypt	n/d	CADMUS NAC (SABIS) in the R3 district	Listed by SABIS
Alburouj, Shorouk	n/d	Egypt	n/d	CADMUS Alburouj (SABIS)	Listed by SABIS
Mivida Gardens	Emaar Misr	Egypt	2.1m m² (210 ha)	International school	Marketed
SODIC East	SODIC	Egypt	655 acres (265 ha)	International school	Marketed
Gardenia City	n/d	Egypt	n/d	Futures Language School (CIRA)	Announced 2025
Badya, West Cairo	Palm Hills	Egypt	n/d	Badya University, operated by Taaleem (higher education)	Opened Sep 2024
Zenata Eco-City	SAZ (CDG group)	Morocco	n/d	CADMUS Zenata (SABIS); 15 ha international university campus	School listed; campus planned
Eko Atlantic, Lagos	South Energyx Nigeria	Nigeria	10m m²; 300,000 residents planned	Rugby School	Marketed
Appolonia City, Greater Accra	Rendeavour	Ghana	1,000 ha; 25,000 homes, 100,000 residents planned	Schools in the social infrastructure plan	Planned

Source: Rendeavour (Tatu City, Appolonia City, 2026); Nova Pioneer; SABIS Africa network; Emaar Misr; SODIC; CIRA FY2024/25 release; Taaleem and Palm Hills; Zenata Eco-City (SAZ); Eko Atlantic. n/d: not stated in the sources reviewed.

The schools serve three purposes for a developer. Developers market them to families early in a project, when little else is built. They bring a daily population, as Tatu City's student numbers show. And in Egypt's new cities they give operators land where demand is forming, which matters for mid-market fees such as CIRA's (Chapter 4).

In Ghana, Rendeavour lists schools in the social infrastructure plan for Appolonia City, a 1,000-hectare site planned for 25,000 homes and 100,000 residents. In Lagos, Eko Atlantic markets Rugby School as part of its education offer on 10 million m² of reclaimed land. What is missing almost everywhere is the evidence buyers and lenders need: seats, utilisation and the land terms given to the school.

0.86

students per resident at Tatu City today (Heirstone analysis)

11

communities in the table above; we found no published school land terms for any of them

A FRAMEWORK FOR DEVELOPERS AND OPERATORS

The Heirstone School Site Test: seven questions to answer before a school plot is signed

Most school plots in new communities are agreed on the strength of a brand and a site plan. The test below puts the evidence of this report into seven questions. Each has a pass mark drawn from the operators and markets we examined.

EXHIBIT 20

A school site should pass on fill, fee cover and tenure before it is signed; the other four tests shape the design

Heirstone School Site Test: questions, pass marks and the evidence behind them

	TEST	QUESTION	PASS MARK (HEIRSTONE)	EVIDENCE IN THIS REPORT
1	**Fill**	Will each phase open close to full?	Phase so that each building passes 80% utilisation before the next is built	Curro 69 to 72% for seven years; ADvTECH 84%; CIRA 93.6%; property per pupil rises steeply below 80% (Exhibits 9, 10)
2	**Age ladder**	Does phase one serve the age band that is growing?	First phase matches the fastest-growing band, or early years	Egypt's 15 to 19 band +13.9%; pre-primary private shares of 84% in Morocco and 67% in Cameroon (Exhibits 2, 5)
3	**Fee cover**	Does the fee pay for the seat?	Property per seat no more than 1.5 years of the target fee	Curro 1.5 years; ADvTECH 1.2 (Exhibit 13)
4	**Land per seat**	Is the plot sized to the operator's model?	Land per seat stated and justified, between about 2 and 60 m²	Kenya's urban minimum about 2 m² per seat for 1,000 pupils; Curro 57 m² per built seat (Exhibit 14)
5	**Tenure**	Does the tenure outlast the payback?	Lease or title at least twice the expected payback, so 9 to 17 years or more	Paybacks of 4.4 to 8.4 years; Kenya registration minimum 8 years; Crawford 99 years (Exhibit 17)
6	**Property holder**	Who owns the buildings if the operator changes?	A named holder for land and buildings, with an education-use covenant	CIRA sukuk on four schools; Curro owned by a public benefit trust; leases elsewhere (Exhibits 16, 18)
7	**Fee capacity**	Can local households pay the fee?	Fee benchmarked against GDP per head and comparable schools in the catchment	Mass and mid-market fees of 0.2 to 0.9 times GDP per head; a premium Nairobi school at 8 to 9 times (Exhibit 12)

Source: Heirstone analysis drawing on the sources of Exhibits 2 to 18. Pass marks are Heirstone judgements based on the operators examined and have no regulatory status.

A How to use it

Score each test pass, marginal or fail. A plot that fails fill, fee cover or tenure should be redesigned before it is signed, whatever the other scores.

B Who applies it

Developers allocating plots, operators choosing between sites, and lenders or property investors asked to fund the buildings.

C What it leaves out

Curriculum, accreditation and teaching quality, which decide demand within a catchment and need their own diligence.

CHAPTER 7

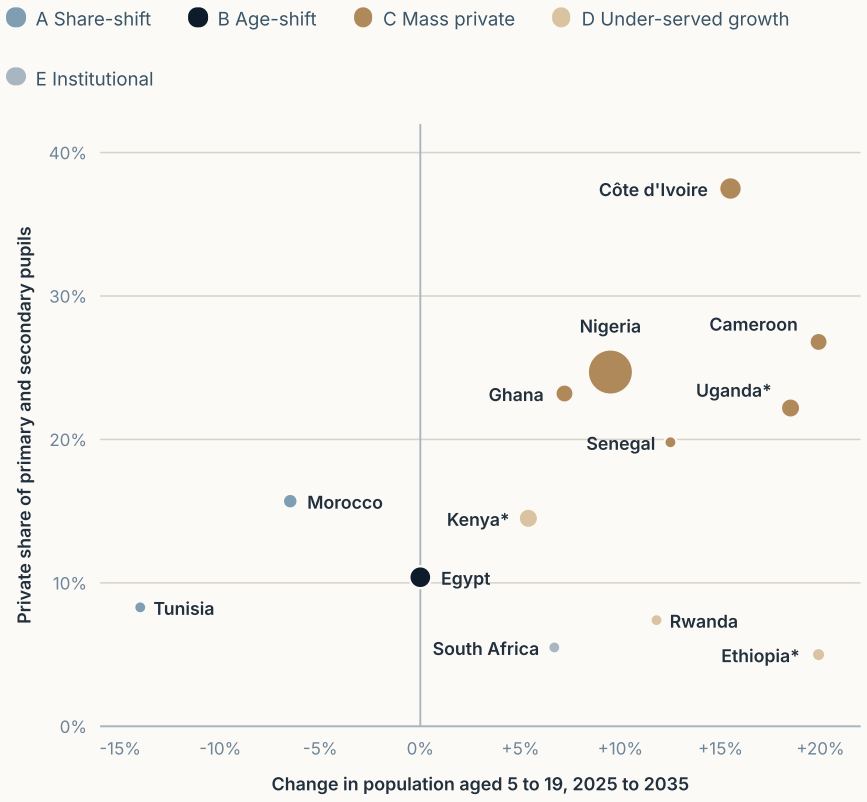
Five kinds of market, from the Maghreb to the Cape

Set private share against the growth of the school-age population and the 13 markets fall into five groups, each calling for a different real estate strategy.

EXHIBIT 21

Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon pair high private shares with fast-growing cohorts; Ethiopia grows as fast with a private share of 5%

Private share of primary and secondary pupils, latest UIS year, against change in population aged 5 to 19, 2025 to 2035, %; circle area shows private pupils; colour shows Heirstone market group



Source: UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI; World Bank population projections (source 40). **Heirstone analysis** and grouping. * Share predates 2019.

The two axes are the numbers a school investor most needs and finds hardest to assemble: how many families already pay for school, and how many more children are coming. Kenya, Uganda and Ethiopia carry an asterisk because their private shares predate 2019; on current national data they may sit elsewhere on the chart.

A Share-shift

Morocco, Tunisia. Shrinking cohorts, rising private shares. Upgrade and consolidate.

B Age-shift

Egypt. Stable cohort shifting to the upper-school years; listed operator 94% full. Add upper-school seats at low cost per seat.

C Mass private

Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon, Nigeria, Ghana, Senegal, Uganda. Shares of 20 to 38%, growing cohorts, no listed group. Consolidate and finance the property.

D Under-served growth

Ethiopia, Rwanda, Kenya. Low recorded shares, growing cohorts, strong demand at premium schools in Addis Ababa and Nairobi. Buy and extend.

E Institutional

South Africa. Low share, two scaled groups, spare seats and bad debts. Fill what is built.

NORTH AFRICA

In North Africa private growth comes from share and upgrade, with Egypt adding upper-school demand

Egypt

Egypt has about 2.8 million private primary and secondary pupils by our calculation: 8.5% of primary and 13.0% of secondary enrolment. Its listed operator is close to full. CIRA used 93.6% of 40,000 seats in the nine months to May 2026 and targets 70,000 K-12 seats by 2030, about 30,000 more seats in four years. It earned about EGP 33,700 of K-12 revenue per pupil in 2024/25, US$684 at the 2025 average rate of EGP 49.23, or 0.22 times GDP per head. K-12 revenue rose 25% in pounds in 2024/25 and 26% in the nine months to May 2026.

At those fees, compact sites and dense buildings keep the property per seat in proportion, and the new cities supply the land. CIRA bought a 20,000 m^2 plot in New Rashid for a language school and is opening in Gardenia City; SABIS runs CADMUS schools in the New Administrative Capital and at Alburouj; Mivida Gardens and SODIC East market on-site international schools. Egypt is also where school property has been refinanced in the capital market, through CIRA's EGP 600m ijara sukuk. The demographic case points to preparatory and secondary years, where the 15 to 19 band grows 13.9%.

Gulf operators are present mainly in Egypt. GEMS Education, based in Dubai, lists 52 schools across the UAE, Qatar and Egypt and no school in Sub-Saharan Africa. Four of the six schools in SABIS's Africa network are in Egypt.

Morocco

Morocco's private primary share rose from 6.6% in 2005 to 18.3% in 2024, while its population aged 5 to 19 is projected to fall 6.5% by 2035. 83.8% of pre-primary children were in private provision in 2019. Inspired's King's Group in Rabat and SABIS's CADMUS Zenata represent the international groups. In a shrinking market, growth comes from share and quality, which favours buying and upgrading existing schools over greenfield capacity.

Tunisia

Tunisia's private primary share rose eight-fold, from 1.1% in 2005 to 9.1% in 2023, and 79.2% of pre-primary children were in private provision in 2016. Its population aged 5 to 9 falls 26.9% by 2035 while the 15 to 19 band grows 9.9%. New private capacity there competes for fewer young children; early years and upper secondary are the segments with room.

Algeria

Algeria records 1.8% of primary and of secondary pupils in private schools, the lowest share of any country in this report. On current data there is no private school real estate market of scale to analyse.

70,000

CIRA's K-12 seat target for 2030, from 40,000 today

93.6%

of CIRA's 40,000 K-12 seats in use in the nine months to May 2026

18.3%

Morocco's private primary share in 2024, from 6.6% in 2005

-26.9%

change in Tunisia's population aged 5 to 9 by 2035

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

South of the Sahara, the largest private markets are francophone and West African, and the scaled operators are mostly elsewhere

Francophone West and Central Africa

Côte d'Ivoire has the highest private secondary share we found: 63.3% of secondary pupils, about 2.1 million, and a primary share that doubled from 9.7% in 2008 to 20.0% in 2024. Its 15 to 19 population grows 25.6% by 2035. At a constant private share, Heirstone scenario A puts the need at about 400,000 more private secondary places. Cameroon records 25.3% at primary, 30.6% at secondary and 67.5% at pre-primary, with a 15 to 19 band growing 26.6%. Senegal records 18.9% and 21.5%, and the Democratic Republic of Congo 10.9% and 19.8%.

The statistics count faith-based and community schools as private, so these shares include more than commercial schools. French-accredited schools form an international tier: the AEFE network counts 640 schools in 140 countries, with more than 400,000 pupils. Enko Education runs 19 schools in 11 African countries with more than 10,000 learners. The constraint in francophone West and Central Africa is capital and disclosure.

Nigeria and Ghana

Nigeria has about 12 million private pupils, 23.3% of primary and 27.9% of secondary enrolment, and a 5 to 19 population that grows by 8.4 million by 2035. The naira averaged NGN 1,479 to the dollar in 2024 and 1,518 in 2025. Greensprings, a premium school with three Lagos campuses, does not publish a fee table online, and Eko Atlantic markets Rugby School. NewGlobe reports supporting state programmes in Edo, Kwara, Lagos, Bayelsa and Jigawa; those are public schools. Ghana records 28.4% private at primary and 15.4% at secondary. Rendeavour plans schools within Appolonia City for 100,000 residents.

East Africa

Kenya's latest international figure is 16.0% private at primary, from 2014, so national data should be checked before any investment case. ADvTECH has built a Kenyan platform since entering with Crawford in 2018: Makini's nine campuses, Crawford, and Makini Runda. Brookhouse charges KSh 840,000 a term in day tuition for Years 7 and 8, about US$19,500 a year at the 2025 average rate. ADvTECH is spending R39m to more than double Makini Statehouse in Nairobi to 575 places by December 2026. Ethiopia records 4.4% at primary but adds 9.5 million children aged 5 to 19 by 2035; Flipper's 1,300 applications for 300 places and its 450-place extension point to unmet premium demand. Uganda's last figures, 19.6% at primary in 2017, are dated. Rwanda's primary share nearly tripled, to 6.5%, from 2010 to 2024.

Southern Africa and the islands

South Africa is the institutional market: 5.8% of primary pupils in private schools, two scaled groups, and the clearest evidence of the empty-seat problem. ADvTECH's South African school enrolment grew 1% in the first half of 2026 at a 20.9% margin. In Botswana, ADvTECH's Gaborone International School has 3,300 students on state leasehold land. Mauritius records 56.4% of secondary pupils in largely grant-aided private schools, and Angola 33.5%.

2.1m

private secondary pupils in Côte d'Ivoire, 63.3% of the total

400k

more private secondary seats needed there by 2035 at a constant share

9.5m

more children aged 5 to 19 in Ethiopia by 2035, the largest increase of the 13 markets

4.3x

applications per place at Flipper, Addis Ababa

COUNTRY BY COUNTRY

Thirteen markets, five strategies: where we would start in each

EXHIBIT 22

The mass-private markets of West and Central Africa need the most seats and have the fewest published operators

Private share, cohort change, seat scenarios, operators and Heirstone entry view, by country

COUNTRY	GROUP	PRIVATE SHARE, PRIMARY / SECONDARY, %	AGES 5 TO 19, 2025 TO 2035	EXTRA PRIVATE SEATS, A / B, THOUSANDS	OPERATORS NAMED IN PUBLIC SOURCES	WHERE WE WOULD START
NORTH AFRICA						
Egypt	B	8.5 / 13.0	0.0%	-39 / -24	CIRA (listed); SABIS, GEMS	Upper-school seats in new cities at low cost per seat; refinance owned schools
Morocco	A	18.3 / 12.3	-6.5%	-97 / 88	Inspired (King's Group), SABIS	Buy and upgrade existing schools; early years
Tunisia	A	9.1 / 7.2*	-14.0%	-35 / 37	n/d	Early years and upper secondary only
FRANCOPHONE WEST AND CENTRAL AFRICA						
Côte d'Ivoire	C	20.0 / 63.3	+15.5%	510 / 893	No listed group found	Mid-fee secondary campuses; property vehicles to consolidate
Cameroon	C	25.3 / 30.6	+19.9%	378 / 569	No listed group found	Pre-primary and secondary phases in growing cities
Senegal	C	18.9 / 21.5	+12.5%	89 / 200	No listed group found	Selective mid-fee campuses in Dakar
ANGLOPHONE WEST AFRICA						
Nigeria	C	23.3 / 27.9	+9.5%	1,001 / 4,590	Greensprings and other premium schools; no listed group found	Consolidation and long-lease property; new-city sites in Lagos
Ghana	C	28.4 / 15.4	+7.2%	106 / 533	Legacy Girls' College (fund-backed)	Secondary capacity; Appolonia-type community sites
EAST AFRICA						
Kenya	D	16.0* / 12.7*	+5.4%	116 / 979	ADvTECH, Inspired, Nova Pioneer, SABIS	Buy and extend; long leases; community anchors
Ethiopia	D	4.4 / 6.6*	+19.9%	222 / 222	ADvTECH (Flipper)	Premium and mid-fee extensions; owned main sites
Uganda	C	19.6* / 44.6*	+18.5%	400 / 1,439	n/d	Verify current data before committing capital
Rwanda	D	6.5 / 10.6	+11.8%	35 / 168	n/d	Small premium campuses in Kigali
SOUTHERN AFRICA						
South Africa	E	5.8 / 5.1	+6.7%	60 / 256	Curro, ADvTECH, Inspired, Nova Pioneer	Fill existing seats; brownfield conversions; property vehicles

Source: UNESCO UIS via World Bank WDI; World Bank population projections (source 40); company and operator websites and reports cited in Chapters 1 to 6. **Heirstone analysis** for groups, seat scenarios and entry views. * Share predates 2019. "No listed group found" refers to listed K-12 school groups in the sources reviewed. Egypt's seat figures combine fewer primary seats with about 40,000 more secondary seats.

The table reads across from demand to supply. Where private shares are high and cohorts growing, as in Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon and Nigeria, the constraint is capital in a form that schools can use: long leases, property vehicles and lenders willing to take school buildings as security. Where cohorts shrink, as in Morocco and Tunisia, the opportunity is consolidation and quality, and greenfield seats compete with existing ones.

Egypt and East Africa sit between. Both have operators that fill their schools and publish their numbers, both have developers allocating school land in new communities, and both reward buying or extending over building from scratch. In South Africa capital arrived before pupils, and the seats already exist: Curro alone had about 31,000 empty built seats in 2024.

RECOMMENDATIONS

What each party should do next, tied to the evidence in this report

GOVERNMENTS, MINISTRIES OF EDUCATION AND LAND AGENCIES

1 **Publish private enrolment and capacity every year.**
The latest international primary figures for Kenya, Uganda and Ethiopia date from 2014, 2017 and 2021. Enrolment and seat counts by district and fee band let planners and investors see where seats are short.

2 **Match registration tenure to the life of the buildings.**
Kenya registers a school on an eight-year lease, shorter than Curro's 8.4-year payback. A longer minimum for purpose-built schools would make them easier to finance.

3 **Publish the terms of school plots in new towns.**
Developers from Tatu City to Zenata name schools as anchors but rarely publish the land terms (Exhibit 19). Tendering plots by fee band, with land price linked to seats delivered, would attract operators that fill buildings.

4 **Allow school property to be held apart from the school.**
Education-use covenants and a recognised property vehicle, as CIRA's ijara sukuk shows in Egypt, let landlords and lenders fund school buildings without running schools.

MASTER DEVELOPERS

1 **Reserve school land in phase one and build it in steps.**
Tatu City has more than 6,000 students against just over 7,000 residents. Open early years first, where private shares are highest, and add buildings as each phase passes 80% utilisation.

2 **Size the plot to the operator, and say why.**
Sites range from 0.2 hectares on Kenya's urban minimum to Curro's 7.3-hectare average and Wellington's 12.1. Use the School Site Test before signing.

3 **Keep or place the property, and lease it to the operator.**
A developer that holds the school building on a long lease keeps control of the anchor and can later sell it as an income asset.

SCHOOL OPERATORS

1 **Grow by buying and extending where seats already fill.**
Regis Runda cost R85,600 per built seat and Flipper about R45,000 per pupil, against R114,000 to R169,000 per added place on extensions.

2 **Publish built and ultimate utilisation.**
Curro and ADvTECH do; it is the number lenders and landlords need first.

3 **Look west.**
Côte d'Ivoire, Cameroon and Nigeria hold the largest private shares and growing cohorts, with no listed group in the sources reviewed.

INVESTORS, PENSION FUNDS, LENDERS AND DFIS

1 **Underwrite utilisation before demand.**
Ask for seven years of utilisation history. Curro grew learners 42% while utilisation held at 69 to 72%.

2 **Use the price benchmarks.**
By our calculation, about US$5,600 of book property per built seat in South Africa, 0.97 times book in the Curro take-private, and US$2,500 to US$4,800 for recent East African purchases.

3 **Build school property vehicles.**
Long leases to proven operators, rent cover tested at 70% and 85% utilisation, and education-use covenants turn schools into an income asset that pension funds and insurers can hold.

4 **Price the currency.**
Fees are in local currency. ADvTECH reported strong local-currency growth outside South Africa, partly offset by a stronger rand in the first half of 2026. Model fee growth in local currency and convert at each year's rate.

5 **For DFIs that can fund K-12 property, use guarantees.**
A partial guarantee lifted Acorn's student housing notes one notch above Kenya's sovereign rating; the same tool could fund school property vehicles.

NOTES, DEFINITIONS AND SOURCES

How the numbers were built

Definitions

Private share: pupils in institutions not run by a public authority, as a share of all pupils at that level (UNESCO UIS). It includes faith-based, community and grant-aided schools. **Private pupils**: enrolment multiplied by private share; years can differ between the two. **Built or existing capacity**: seats in buildings that exist. **Eventual or ultimate capacity**: seats a site can hold when fully developed. **Utilisation**: pupils as a share of capacity. **Property**: property, plant and equipment at book value (historical cost).

Method

Seat scenarios: scenario A holds the latest private share and scales primary enrolment by the average growth of ages 5 to 9 and 10 to 14, and secondary by ages 10 to 14 and 15 to 19. Scenario B extends each primary share at its past-decade pace to 2035, capped at ten points, and holds secondary shares. They are calculations and imply no forecast. **Property per seat**: segment or group PPE divided by built seats; Curro′s built seats are average learners divided by built utilisation. **Payback**: PPE divided by annual operating profit (Curro: EBITDA); undiscounted, before maintenance capital and land value. **Currency**: World Bank official annual averages (PA.NUS.FCRF): ZAR 18.33 (2024) and 17.89 (2025); EGP 45.30 and 49.23; KES 134.8 and 129.3; NGN 1,479 and 1,518. Amounts from 2025 and 2026 use 2025 rates. EGP and KES amounts from 2019 and 2020 are shown in local currency because exchange rates have since moved.

Sources by chapter

1 and 2: World Bank WDI, UNESCO UIS series SE.PRE/PRM/SEC.PRIV.ZS, SE.PRM.ENRL, SE.SEC.ENRL, NY.GDP.PCAP.CD; World Bank Population estimates and projections (source 40, July 2026); Curro AIR 2024; ADvTECH FY2025 results; CIRA releases.

3 and 4: Curro results presentations FY2023, FY2024 and H1 2025, long-form announcements FY2024 and H1 2025, AIR 2024; ADvTECH long-form results FY2025, analyst presentation FY2025, interim results H1 2026, Strategy Day transcript (Nov 2024), AIR 2025; CIRA earnings releases FY2024/25, 1H and 9M FY2026, Integrated Report (Mar 2023); Kenya Ministry of Education, Basic Standard Requirements for Registration (Dec 2022); Brookhouse Schools fee schedule.

5: Curro firm intention announcement (Aug 2025), combined circular (Oct 2025), finalisation announcement (Dec 2025), AFS 2024; ADvTECH AFS 2025; CIRA sukuk EGM material (Dec 2020) and credentials deck (Apr 2025); IFC education page; Proparco; PIDG.

6: Rendeavour; Nova Pioneer; SABIS; Emaar Misr; SODIC; Palm Hills and Taaleem; Zenata Eco-City; Eko Atlantic.

7: as above, plus AEFE (aefe.gouv.fr), Inspired, GEMS Education, Cognita, Enko Education, NewGlobe, Greensprings and Peponi websites, accessed 2026.

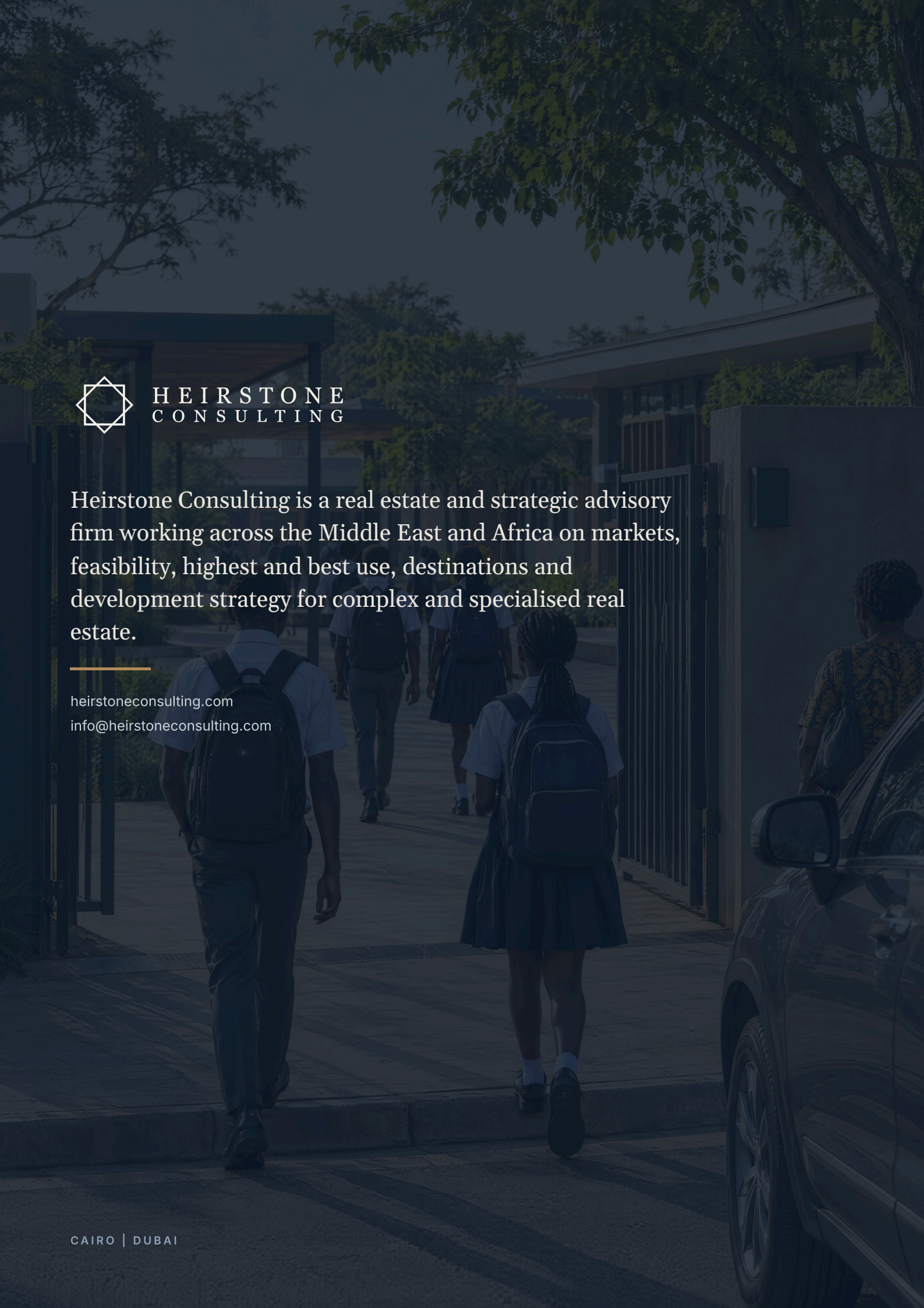
Limitations

UIS series for Kenya, Uganda, Ethiopia and Tunisia (secondary) predate 2019. Curro′s annual fees assume 12 monthly payments. ADvTECH utilisation and school counts are taken from presentation summaries. Map positions are approximate. Few operators outside South Africa and Egypt publish capacity, land or capital data.

Use of this report

This report is based on public information current in 2026 and is provided for general information. It is not investment advice and should not be relied on without independent verification. Heirstone Consulting accepts no liability for decisions made on the basis of it. Figures labelled Heirstone analysis are our calculations from the inputs stated. Images are illustrative.

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